Minutes: AKI after Cardiac Surgery and Protein Intake

- **Date:** October 26, 2026
- **Time:** 4:30–5:00 pm
- **Location:** Zoom Workplace
- **Present:** Prof. Dr. med. Wolfgang Hartl, Johannes Piller, Tom Baumann, Aymen Feki, Yassine Ben Ahmed, Ilyes Ihidheb, Jonas Ziegler

1. Research question

- Does the amount of amino acid intake after cardiac surgery affect the development of acute kidney injury (AKI)?
- **Primary outcome variable:** new AKI diagnosed after day 4 after ICU admission until in-ICU death or discharge alive
- **Secondary outcome variable:** new AKI diagnosed on day 5 or 6 after ICU admission

2. Data

- Dataset: 350 patients, high data quality
- Patients with AKI before surgery are excluded
- Statistical challenge: 10–15% of patients die after surgery. For these patients, it cannot be observed whether protein intake would have affected kidney function (risk of selection bias)
- Randomized trials are the preferred design for this question
- Possible other sources of bias in the data must be considered

3. Decisions

- Statistical questions: contact Johannes Piller
- Medical questions: contact Prof. Dr. Wolfgang Hartl
- Data must never be pushed to GitHub. Store it locally and exclude it via `.gitignore`
- Data must not be uploaded to any AI tools
- AI extensions such as GitHub Copilot must be disabled when working with the data

4. Open questions

- Review the dataset: randomized or non-randomized, observational or not?
- Find an approach for handling patients who die after surgery

5. Next meetings

- Meetings with Johannes Piller take place via Zoom at 7:00 am or after 5:00 pm
- Next meeting: to be determined (Zoom)